

Absolutely — **both** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it here:

> “...so her tiny garden is **both practical and beautiful**.”

Here **both** means that **two qualities are true at the same time**: the garden is practical **and** beautiful.

Word family: **both**

Base word: both

Part of speech: determiner (限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / correlative conjunction pattern (相關連接結構)

Useful patterns: both + plural noun, both of, both...and..., they both, both sides, both ways

Unlike many lexical words, **both** does not have a large derivational family. Its learning value is mainly grammatical.

Meaning in your passage: **both A and B = A 和 B 兩者都..... ; 既.....又.....**

Your sentence:

> “Her tiny garden is **both practical and beautiful**.”

Here **both** joins two adjectives:

> practical

> beautiful

and says **both qualities apply simultaneously**.

繁體中文 :

兩種特質同時成立 ; 既.....又.....

Natural translation:

> “Her tiny garden is both practical and beautiful.”

「她小小的花園**既實用又漂亮**。」

So here:

> **both practical and beautiful = 既實用又漂亮**

1. **both + plural noun (兩者都)** — 兩個都；雙方都

The core determiner use.

Practice 1

> “**Both plants** need more sunlight.”

「**兩棵植物都**需要更多陽光。」

Practice 2

> “Both students passed the exam.”

「**兩名學生都**通過了考試。」

both + plural noun = 已知只有兩個人 / 事物，而這兩者全部都符合某情況

Important:

> both plants 

> *both plant* 

Because **both** refers to two, the noun is plural.

2. **both of + the/these/those/possessive/pronoun (特定兩者)** —兩個都

A major specific-group pattern.

Practice 3

> “**Both of these plants** are healthy.”

「**這兩棵植物都**很健康。」

Practice 4

> “Both of my sisters live nearby.”

「我的**兩個姐妹都**住在附近。」

both of = 某一組特定的兩個人 / 事物全部

Common:

- * both of the students
- * both of these plants
- * both of my parents
- * both of them

3. **both = pronoun, the two of them — 兩者都；兩個都**

No noun follows.

Practice 5

> “Which plant do you like?”

> “I like **both**.”

「你喜歡哪一棵植物？」

「**兩棵我都喜歡**。」

Practice 6

> “Both were ready.”

「**兩個都**準備好了。」

both — pronoun = 已知兩個人 / 事物中的兩者全部

4. **both...and... (兩項同時成立) — 既.....又..... ;和.....都**

This is your exact source structure.

Practice 7 — Original

> “The garden is **both practical and beautiful**.”

「這個花園**既實用又漂亮**。」

Practice 8

> “She grows **both vegetables and flowers**.”

「她**蔬菜和花卉都種**。」

Practice 9

> “Gardening can be **both relaxing and rewarding**.”

「園藝可以**既令人放鬆，又有成就感**。」

both A and B = A 與 B 兩項都成立、都包括在內

This can connect:

* adjectives

* nouns

* verbs

* phrases

* clauses

5. **both + verbs / verb phrases (兩個動作都) — 既.....又.....**

Practice 10

> “She **both grows and shares** vegetables.”

「她**既種蔬菜，也會把蔬菜分享給別人**。」

Practice 11

> “The project **both saves money and reduces waste**.”

「這個項目**既節省金錢，又減少廢物**。」

both = 強調同一主語進行兩個動作 / 具備兩個作用

Parallel grammar matters:

> both grows **and shares** ✓

Keep the paired elements grammatically parallel.

6. **both + subjects** (兩個主體都) — 兩者都

Practice 12

> “**Both Anna and Ben** enjoy gardening.”

「Anna 和 Ben 兩個都喜歡園藝。」

Practice 13

> “**Both the teacher and the students** agreed.”

「老師和學生雙方都同意。」

both A and B = A、B 兩個主體都符合後面的敘述

7. **subject + both + main verb** (兩人 / 兩物都做某事) — 都

A very common word-order pattern.

Practice 14

> “**They both enjoy** gardening.”

「他們兩個都喜歡園藝。」

Practice 15

> “**The plants both need** more water.”

「這兩棵植物都需要更多水。」

subject + both + main verb = 主語所指的兩個人 / 事物都進行該動作

8. **subject + be + both + complement** — 兩者都.....

With **be**, **both** usually comes after the verb.

Practice 16

> “**They are both tired**.”

「他們**兩個都累了**。」

Practice 17

> “The plants are both healthy.”

「這兩棵植物**都很健康**。」

Pattern:

> subject + be + both

not usually:

> *They both are tired*

> though possible for special emphasis.

9. **subject + auxiliary/modal + both + verb — 兩者都會 / 都已 / 都可以.....**

Practice 18

> “They have **both finished**.”

「他們**兩個都完成了**。」

Practice 19

> “The plants can both survive outdoors.”

「這兩種植物**都可以**在戶外存活。」

Typical placement:

> auxiliary/modal + both + main verb

Examples:

* have both finished

* can both grow

* will both come

10. **both sides (兩邊 / 雙方) — 兩邊 ; 雙方**

A very common lexicalized pattern.

Practice 20

> “There are flowers on **both sides** of the path.”

「小徑**兩旁**都有花。」

Practice 21

> “Both sides agreed to continue the discussion.”

「**雙方**都同意繼續討論。」

both sides = 兩個相對的邊 / 兩個對立或參與的一方

Literal or figurative.

11. **both ends** (兩端) — 兩端 ; 兩頭

Practice 22

> “Hold the rope at **both ends**.”

「抓住繩子的**兩端**。」

Practice 23

> “The road is closed at both ends.”

「道路**兩端**都封閉了。」

both ends = 一件東西的兩個端點全部

12. **both ways** (兩個方向 / 兩種方式) — 兩邊 ; 兩個方向 ; 兩種方法都

Practice 24

> “Look **both ways** before crossing.”

「過馬路前要看**左右兩邊**。」

Practice 25

> “The rule works both ways.”

「這條規則**雙向都適用 / 對雙方都一樣**。」

both ways = 兩個方向、兩種方式或對雙方都成立

13. **go both ways (雙向適用) — 對雙方都成立**

A useful figurative expression.

Practice 26

> “Respect should **go both ways**.”

「尊重應該是**雙向的 / 雙方都要有**。」

Practice 27

> “Communication has to go both ways.”

「溝通必須是**雙向的**。」

go both ways = 某種責任、影響、關係或原則對雙方都適用

14. **not both = 並非兩個都.....**

An important logic pattern.

Practice 28

> “The two plants are **not both healthy**.”

「這兩棵植物**並非兩棵都健康**。」

This means:

> at least one is not healthy.

It does **not** necessarily mean:

> neither is healthy.

Practice 29

> “They did not both agree.”

「他們**並不是兩個都同意**。」

not both = 否定「兩者全部」，即至少其中一個不符合

This is a very useful logic distinction.

15. **both not... (不建議的模糊結構) **

Learners should generally avoid:

> *They both didn't agree.*

because this can be ambiguous.

Safer:

If neither agreed:

> “Neither of them agreed.”

「兩個都不同意。」

If only one failed to agree:

> “They did not both agree.”

「並非兩個都同意。」

This is an important precision point.

16. **both of whom / both of which (關係結構) — 兩者都.....**

A useful formal structure.

Practice 30

> “She has two sisters, ****both of whom**** live abroad.”

「她有兩個姐妹，****兩個都****住在海外。」

Practice 31

> “The garden has two lemon trees, both of which are healthy.”

「花園有兩棵檸檬樹，****兩棵都****很健康。」

****both of whom/which = 前面提到的兩個人 / 事物全部****

Register: especially written/formal.

17. ****we both / you both / they both — 我們 / 你們 / 他們兩個都****

A highly useful pronoun pattern.

Practice 32

> “****We both**** enjoy gardening.”

「****我們兩個都****喜歡園藝。」

Practice 33

> “You both did a great job.”

「****你們兩個都****做得很好。」

****pronoun + both = 明確表示該代名詞所指的兩個人全部****

18. ****both...and... with negatives (兩個負面特質都) — 既.....又.....****

Practice 34

> “The task was ****both difficult and tiring****.”

「這項任務****既困難又累人****。」

Practice 35

> “The room was both dark and cold.”

「房間**既昏暗又寒冷**。」

both...and... itself is neutral; it can join positive or negative qualities.

Important distinction: **both vs all**

You just curated **all**.

both

= exactly two.

all

= the complete group, normally three or more or an unspecified entire amount.

> “Both plants survived.”

= 兩棵植物都活下來。

> “All five plants survived.”

= 五棵植物全部活下來。

So:

> exactly two → **both** is normally preferred.

Important distinction: **both vs either**

both

= the two together.

either

= one or the other of two; sometimes each of two in certain contexts.

> “I like both.”

= 兩個都喜歡。

> “Either is fine.”

= 任何一個都可以。

So:

> both = 兩者都

> either = 兩者之一 / 任何一個

Important distinction: **both vs neither**

both

= two are true.

neither

= not one and not the other.

> “Both are healthy.”

= 兩個都健康。

> “Neither is healthy.”

= 兩個都不健康。

They are logical opposites in many two-item contexts.

Important distinction: **both vs each**

both

looks at the two together.

each

emphasizes the two individually.

> “Both plants need water.”

= 兩棵都需要水。

> “Each plant needs a different amount of water.”

= 每棵植物各自需要不同水量。

So:

****both = 兩者作為整體****

****each = 逐一看每一個****

Important distinction: ****both vs two****

**two**

simply gives number.

> “Two plants survived.”

= 有兩棵植物活下來。

**both**

means all of a known pair.

> “Both plants survived.”

= 已知那兩棵植物****兩棵都****活下來。

So ****both**** carries the idea of completeness within a pair.

Important distinction: ****both of vs both****

General noun phrase:

> “Both plants are healthy.”

Specific determiner:

> “Both of the plants are healthy.”

Both are possible when referring to a known pair.

But with pronouns:

> both of them 

> *both them* 

Important distinction: ****both...and vs not only...but also****

Both can join two positive pieces of information.

****both A and B****

neutral and balanced.

> “She is both patient and careful.”

****not only A but also B****

more emphatic; B often feels like an additional or surprising point.

> “She is not only patient but also extremely creative.”

So:

> both...and = 既.....又.....

> not only...but also = 不但.....而且.....

Important distinction: ****both...and vs either...or****

****both A and B****

= A and B are both true/included.

****either A or B****

= one of the two alternatives.

> “You can grow both herbs and flowers.”

= 兩樣都可以種。

> “You can grow either herbs or flowers.”

= 兩者選其一。

Important distinction: **both...and** vs **neither...nor**

both A and B

= both included.

neither A nor B

= both excluded.

> both practical and beautiful

> = 既實用又漂亮

> neither practical nor beautiful

> = 既不實用也不漂亮

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **both of them** vs **the two of them**

These are very close.

both of them

emphasizes:

both members satisfy a statement.

> “Both of them passed.”

the two of them

simply identifies the pair.

> “The two of them walked home.”

So **both** often has stronger “兩個都” force.

Important distinction: ****not both vs neither****

This one is crucial.

****not both****

= at least one does not.

> “They are not both ready.”

Possibilities:

* one ready, one not;

* neither ready.

****neither****

= definitely zero of the two.

> “Neither is ready.”

= 兩個都沒有準備好。

So:

> ****not both ≠ necessarily neither****

Grammar note: agreement

Because ****both**** refers to two, it normally takes plural agreement.

> Both plants ****are**** healthy. 

> Both students ****have**** finished. 

Not:

> *Both plants is healthy.* 

Grammar note: parallel structure in ****both...and****

Keep the paired elements grammatically balanced.

Good:

> both ****practical and beautiful****

> both ****grows vegetables and shares them****

Better still for perfect parallelism:

> both ****grows vegetables and shares vegetables****

Avoid mismatches such as:

> ***She both enjoys gardening and the outdoors.*** ❌

Better:

> **"She enjoys both gardening and the outdoors."**

Family / pattern sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory is:

- * ****both + plural noun**** = 兩個都
- * ****both of + specific pair**** = 特定兩者都
- * ****both — pronoun**** = 兩者都
- * ****both...and...**** = 既.....又.....
- * ****subject + both + verb**** = 兩者都做.....
- * ****be + both**** = 兩者都處於某狀態
- * ****auxiliary + both + verb**** = 兩者都.....
- * ****both sides**** = 兩邊 / 雙方
- * ****both ends**** = 兩端
- * ****both ways**** = 兩個方向 / 雙向
- * ****go both ways**** = 對雙方都成立
- * ****not both**** = 並非兩者全部
- * ****both of whom/which**** = 兩者都.....
- * ****we/you/they both**** = 我們 / 你們 / 他們兩個都

This is a grammar-heavy target rather than a lexical-polysemy word.

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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both + plural noun	已知兩個人 / 事物，而兩者全部都符合後面的敘述
both of + specific pair	某一組已明確限定的兩個人 / 事物全部
both — pronoun	已知兩者中的兩個全部
both A and B	A、B 兩項同時成立 / 都被包括；既.....又.....
subject + both + verb	主語所指的兩個人 / 事物都進行同一動作
be + both + complement	主語所指兩者都處於同一狀態
auxiliary + both + verb	主語所指兩者都完成 / 能做 / 會做某事
both sides	兩個相對的邊；亦可指參與 / 對立的雙方
both ends	某物的兩個端點全部
both ways	兩個方向、兩種方式，或對雙方都成立
go both ways	某種責任、影響或原則對雙方都適用
not both	否定「兩者全部」；至少其中一個不符合
both of whom/which	前面提到的兩個人 / 事物全部
we/you/they both	該代名詞所指的兩個人全部

For your original sentence

> “...so her tiny garden is ****both practical and beautiful****.”

The exact meaning is:

****both...and... = 「實用」和「漂亮」這兩項特質同時成立****

So naturally:

> ****「所以她小小的花園既實用又漂亮。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****both plants**** → 兩棵植物都
- > ****both of these plants**** → 這兩棵植物都
- > ****both practical and beautiful**** → 既實用又漂亮
- > ****either A or B**** → A 或 B 其中一個
- > ****neither A nor B**** → A、B 兩者都不
- > ****all**** → 全部，通常不限於兩個
- > ****not both**** → 並非兩個都.....
- > ****both ways**** → 雙向 / 兩邊都